

CLAYTON ADAMSON

University of Wisconsin-Madison | Department of Sociology | Center for Demography and Ecology
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social stratification ♦ Economic growth and development ♦ Demography
Migration ♦ Spatial methods ♦ Place

EDUCATION

- In progress **University of Wisconsin–Madison**, Ph.D. in Sociology
- *Preliminary Exams*: demography; social stratification
 - *Minor*: Community Development & Family Policy
 - *Committee*: Katherine J. Curtis; Max Besbris; Megan Doherty Bea; Anton Babkin
- 2022 **Cornell University**, M.S. in Regional Science
- 2019 **University of Minnesota-Twin Cities**, B.S.B. in Accounting; B.S.B. in Finance

RESEARCH ACTIVITY

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Clayton Adamson. (2026). "Unequal Returns to Growth and Decline Across U.S. Regions and Social Classes." *Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy, and Society*. [Link to preprint](#) / [full text](#).

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. (2026). "The Intergenerational Mobility Advantage of Educators' Children: Capital Embedded in Occupations." *Social Science Research*. [Link to full text](#).

Karl Vachuska and **Clayton Adamson**. (2026). "Neighborhood Shocks and Network Dynamics: An Instrumental Variable Approach to Measuring Triadic Closure in Daily Mobility Networks." *Social Networks*. [Link to full text](#).

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Sarah Peters. (2025). "Economic Complexity and Divergent Population Growth by Race and Rurality." *Spatial Demography*, 13(1), 5. [Link to full text](#).

Under Review

* denotes equal authorship

Clayton Adamson. "Uneven Jobs, Uneven Places: Industrial Structure and the Geography of Job Quality" (conditional acceptance at *Population Research and Policy Review*)

Clayton Adamson. "Growth Without Gain: The Adverse Effects of State and Local Development Incentives on Resident Prosperity" (revise and resubmit at *Urban Affairs Review*)

Clayton Adamson. "State-Subsidized Development and Rural Population Change: Migrant Attraction or In-State Reshuffling?" (abstract accepted, invited submission at *Rural Sociology*)

Clayton Adamson. "A Century of Hidden Harm: Alcohol Exposure and Intergenerational Status Attainment" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. "Cost-of-Living Inequality Sustains Racial Earnings Inequality in the United States" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Katherine J. Curtis. "Who Still Benefits from Moving? Declining and Unequal Returns to Internal Migration" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Megan Doherty Bea. "Indebted from the Start: Childcare Costs and Family Financial Trajectories" (under review)

***Clayton Adamson** and *Karl Vachuska. "Expected Years of Homeownership Are Declining for Americans without a BA" (under review)

Nicholas D.E. Mark, **Clayton Adamson**, and Max Besbris. "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era" (under review)

Katherine J. Curtis, Sara A. Peters, **Clayton Adamson**, Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, and Richard A. Dunn. "Economic Structure and the Rural Mortality Penalty: A Spatial Regime Analysis" (under review)

Karl Vachuska, **Clayton Adamson**, Brian Levy, and Max Besbris. "Neighborhoods, Homicide, and Racial Inequality in Life Expectancy: The Impact of Residence and Routine Mobility" (under review)

Technical Reports & Extension

Katherine J. Curtis, Raevan Faye Chandler, **Clayton Adamson**, and Sara A. Peters. "Wisconsin County Migration Trends." *Applied Population Lab*, University of Wisconsin–Madison Extension, November 2025.

Refereed Conference Presentations

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. "Cost-of-Living Inequality Sustains Racial Earnings Inequality in the United States." *Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Spring Meeting 2026, Seville, Spain.*

Clayton Adamson. "Occupations Revisited: How Non-Wage Parental Job Characteristics Shape Children's Attainment." *European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR) Mechanisms of Social Mobility conference, 2026, Zurich, Switzerland.*

Clayton Adamson, and Katherine J. Curtis. "The End of the Migration Premium? Unequal and Declining Returns to Internal Migration in the US." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO.*

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, and Richard A. Dunn. "Rethinking Rural Disadvantage: Economic, Not Geographic, Isolation Patterns Local Social Exclusion." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO.*

Nicholas D.E. Mark, **Clayton Adamson,** and Max Besbris. "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO.*

Sara Peters, **Clayton Adamson,** and Michael Topping. "The Changing Value of Education in U.S. Mortality Trends." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO.*

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, and Richard A. Dunn. "Using network theory to characterize economic, geographic, and social dimensions of isolation." *72nd Annual North American Meetings of the Regional Science Association International, 2025, Denver, CO.*

Sara Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson,** Michael Topping, and Anton Babkin. "Structural Dimensions of Rising Premature Mortality in US: Examining the Role of Economy, Race, and Rurality." *American Sociological Society Annual Meeting, 2025, Chicago, IL.*

Clayton Adamson. "Higher Tech, Lower Opportunity: Regressive Impact of Local Tech Sector on Intergenerational Mobility." *Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Summer Meeting 2025, Los Angeles, CA.*

Clayton Adamson, Sarah Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, and Richard A. Dunn. "Unequal distribution of benefits of regional trade using quantile and spatial modeling." *Rural Sociology Society Annual Meeting, 2024, Madison, WI.*

Sarah Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson,** Anton Babkin, Richard A. Dunn, and Austin Sandler. "Industry and the Rural Mortality Penalty: A Spatial Regime Analysis of Economic Structure and Early Life Mortality in the Rural U.S." *Rural Sociology Society Annual Meeting, 2024, Madison, WI.*

Dunn, Richard A., Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "The Spatial Structure of Economic Exchange and Rural Prosperity in the United States." *Agricultural and Applied Economics Annual Meeting, 2024, New Orleans, LA.*

Dunn, Richard A., Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "Economic Catchment Areas: A New Place Typology Based on Supply Chain Connectedness." *Agricultural and Applied Economics Annual Meeting, 2024, New Orleans, LA.*

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis and Sarah Peters. "Economic complexity and regional and racial variation in population growth in the metropolitan and nonmetropolitan United States." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH.*

Karl Vachuska, **Clayton Adamson**, Brian Levy, and Max Besbris. "Neighborhoods, Homicide, and Racial Inequality in Life Expectancy: The Impact of Residence and Routine Mobility." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH.*

Babkin, Anton, Richard Dunn, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "Economic Catchment Areas: A New Place Typology Based on Potential Supply Chain Connectedness." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH.*

Conference Poster Presentations

Clayton Adamson. "Tech-sector growth, economic polarization, and intergenerational mobility: regressive consequences of contemporary growth coalitions." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Clayton Adamson, Meiyi Li, Max Besbris, and Karl Vachuska. "Lagging housing values and homeowner health: race & place." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Sara Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Michael Topping, and Anton Babkin. "Structural Dimensions of Rising Premature Mortality in the US: An Examination of the Role of the Economy, Race, and Rurality." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Clayton Adamson, Meiyi Li, Max Besbris, and Karl Vachuska. "Lagging housing values and homeowner health: race & place." *HOME: Health, Opportunity, Mobility, and Equity in Housing, a research symposium hosted by the Minnesota Population Center (MPC), 2025, Minneapolis, MN.*

Academic Theses

Clayton Adamson. "Localized job quality index: constructing multidimensional, occupation-level measure of job quality." Cornell University, M.S. 2022.

Clayton Adamson. "When the honeymoon ends: do state and local discretionary tax packages inordinately burden school districts?" University of Minnesota, B.S.B. 2019.

GRANTS

- 2026 NICHD Small Research Grant (R03) – to submit October 2026 – \$50,000
- *Role:* sole author
 - *PIs:* Community Development & Family Policy
 - *Project:* "Who Still Benefits from Moving? Declining and Unequal Returns to Internal Migration"
- 2026 NICHD Small Research Grant (R03) – to submit October 2026 – \$50,000
- *Role:* lead author
 - *Co-PIs:* Max Besbris, Nicholas Mark
 - *Project:* "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era"
- 2026 USDA NIFA AFRI – funded February 2026 – \$650,000
- *Role:* supporting author
 - *PIs:* Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin
 - *Project:* "The Spatial Structure of Economic Exchange and Rural Prosperity in the United States"

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

- Spring 2026 Guest Lecturer: "Quantitative Spatial Econometrics", Spatial Methods Working Group
- 2025-2026 Graduate Student Mentor: Chloe Patterson
- Spring 2025 Guest Lecturer: "Causal Inference in Spatial Methods", Spatial Methods Working Group
- Fall 2024 Guest Lecturer: "Quantitative Spatial Econometrics", Spatial Methods Working Group
- 2024-2026 Graduate Student Mentor: Emma Dewil
- Spring 2024 Guest Lecturer: "Quantitative Spatial Econometrics", Spatial Methods Working Group

SERVICE

Reviewer: *Spatial Demography; Economic Development Quarterly; Journal of Rural Health*

- 2026-2027 Department Hiring Committee

2026-2027	Graduate Student Professional Development & Job Search Committee
2025-2026	Department Undergraduate Curriculum Committee
2025	Co-Facilitator, Spatial Methods Working Group

EMPLOYMENT

2023-present	University of Wisconsin-Madison , Center for Demography and Ecology Predoctoral Research Fellow (Katherine J. Curtis) Research Assistant (Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, Max Besbris, Nicholas D.E. Mark, Megan Doherty Bea) Madison, Wisconsin
2024-2026	Land Strategies Director of Economic Modeling and Analytics (part-time) Greenville, South Carolina
2023-2026	Minneapolis-Saint Paul Economic Development Partnership Research Manager (part-time) Saint Paul, Minnesota
2022-2023	Research Manager (full-time) Saint Paul, Minnesota
2022	The Brookings Institution , Workforce of the Future initiative Research Assistant Washington, D.C.
2019-2021	Grant Thornton LLP Economic Development Incentives Consultant Minneapolis, Minnesota

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

Fellowships

2025-2026	Evelyn T. Crowe Fellowship from the Department of Community and Environmental Sociology at the University of Wisconsin–Madison
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2023-2026 T32 pre-doctoral training grant (T32 HD07014) from the Eunice Kennedy Shriver National Institute of Child Health and Human Development (NICHD)

Professional Distinctions

2019-present Certified Public Accountant (inactive), State of Minnesota

Awards

2026 Travel Award, European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR)

2019 Summa Cum Laude undergraduate thesis, University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

2019 Magna Cum Laude graduate, University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

SKILLS

R (tidyverse, ipumsr, Leaflet, Rmarkdown), Input-Output, Python, ArcGIS, SQL, Overleaf, Geoda, Excel VBA